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Annual Report 2016 – 2017

This has been a busy year for NZRA. Starting from February 2016 to February 2017 we have run two 24 hour championships; one at Waikouaiti and the Australasian Championships at Waikaia. The other major event in the year's calendar was the Heights of Winter, fortunately organised this year by PAPO and their indefatigable organizer Stu Payne.

There have been many other shorter events both locally and throughout NZ, which reinforces our constitutional objective of facilitating the widest possible diversity and participation in rogaining events. In a sense, rogaining has "gone viral" which is the best evolutionary outcome we could wish for in terms of our constitution. Many of these shorter events operate with no input from us, but there are others which we do support, even if to a limited extent.

On the downside, there is less organizer enthusiasm (and support for) the longer 24 hour events, because of the dramatically increased workload and landowner requirements, and the relatively small number of people who actually enter. This is a problem which is also apparent in Australia, the birthplace of Rogaining.

However we need to ensure that these 24 hour championships continue, at a world-class level of standard, in order for our local winners to obtain entry qualification to the World Championships. It is worth mentioning that, like so many other sports in NZ, we punch well above our weight. NZ has a long history of World Championship winners, and we were the most represented country (outside USA) at the WRC in South Dakota, USA, 2014. We are well recognized internationally, as evidenced, among other things, by our contribution to the running of the World Championships in Alice Springs.

We are thin on the ground, but I am sure that with increasing assistance from the many regular participants in Rogaining that we will continue to meet our WRC obligations.

We have had some significant retirements over the last year. Bill Kennedy has at last passed over the website management to Wayne Millow, and the Newsletter to Tim Farrant, but Bill continues to be our main map-maker. Bill has been a founding contributor to NZRA and his contribution exceeds the description of mere words. We do need someone somewhat younger to learn from Bill, the techniques and intricacies of creating maps in OCAD, using Topomap shape files.

Our secretary for over a decade, Grant Hunter, has also passed his portfolio over to Colin Dixon. Grant has been the leading light in getting the NZRA properly constituted, managed, making our insurance robust, meeting our legal obligations, and operating smoothly, in spite of facing many constitutional challenges. Grant has also been foremost in

establishing a Safety culture in NZRA, particularly with the changing legislation relating to liability and traffic management.

We all owe an enormous gratitude to both Bill and Grant, and I give a huge thank you to their successors Wayne, Tim, and Colin.

After 14 years as President, I am now standing down. Age and medical needs have caught up, and I must pass the baton on to someone younger, who can still remember what day it is.

With the Heights of Winter event nearing, we again have an active year ahead of us. I wish everyone an excellent year of rogaining, whether it be in competing or organisation or both.



Peter Squires, President.